Fjord FD-1200 and FD 1200 Low-front display cases: door gasket compound change

Product family	Fjord display cases
Models	FD-1200, FD 1200 Low-front (catalogue name FD-1200L)
Change class	Class C - field replacement on customer complaint only
Originator	Jonas Berge, Design Engineer, Fjord
Change requested by	Service Operations (field feedback, Nordic and DACH regions)
Effectivity (production)	Ålesund plant, from production week 2025-W23
Supersedes	ECN-2024-037, for the FD-1200L only

1. Reason for change

Service technicians in Norway, Sweden and Germany reported hardened and cracked door gaskets on FD-1200 cases within two to three months of commissioning, on cases installed from April 2025, mostly in stores with low indoor humidity. A leaking gasket lets warm air in, causes condensation and frosting on the glass, and raises compressor run time. Two supermarket chains raised the issue with their account managers in May 2025.

Lab ageing tests confirmed that the EPDM compound batch Nordseal supplied from week 10 of 2025 loses elasticity faster than specified at relative humidity below 30%. Earlier batches of the same part, in use since ECN-2024-037, meet the specification.

2. Description of change

	Before	After
Part number	GSK-1200-EPDM	GSK-1200-TPE
Material	EPDM, 60 Shore A	Thermoplastic elastomer, 55 Shore A
Supplier	Nordseal AS (NO)	Nordseal AS (NO), unchanged
Unit cost per door	EUR 18.20	EUR 21.75

The FD-1200 has three doors per case and the FD 1200 Low-front has four. The new gasket fits the existing door profile. No change to the door, hinge or heater wire.

3. Affected items

Cases manufactured at the Ålesund plant from production week 10 to week 22 of 2025 inclusive, that is, cases fitted with GSK-1200-EPDM from the lot introduced at the start of week 10. Serial numbers are not listed in this notice. Service and Sales should determine the affected units from the build date recorded in ERP.

Cases built before week 10 used the earlier gasket lot and have not shown the fault. The FD-900 uses a different gasket (GSK-0900) and is not affected.

Note: some FD-1200L cases built in weeks 10 to 22 were assembled at the Tartu plant during the Ålesund line upgrade in April 2025, using gaskets shipped from Ålesund stock. These cases are affected even though they were not built at Ålesund.

4. Disposition

Stage	Action
Stock	Use up remaining GSK-1200-EPDM on FD-1200 orders for indoor-climate-controlled sites only. Do not use on FD-1200L.
Work in progress	No action.
Finished goods	No action.
Field units	Replace gaskets free of charge if the customer reports frosting, condensation or a visible gasket defect. No proactive campaign.

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5. Service instructions

Use activity code RET-031. Replace all door gaskets on the case, not only the visibly damaged one. Labour is about 20 minutes per door. Where a customer has several affected cases in one store, the account manager should be informed before the visit so that all cases can be done together.

Repeat visits for the same symptom on the same case should be flagged to Fjord Product Engineering, as they may indicate a door alignment problem rather than the gasket.

6. Cost and warranty

Estimated population: about 640 cases. Engineering expects a complaint rate of 15 to 25% over two winters. Parts and labour are covered by warranty in the first 24 months after commissioning. For cases under a full-service contract after that, the replacement is covered by the contract.

7. References

ECN-2024-037 (introduction of GSK-1200-EPDM); lab report LR-FJ-2025-11; Service feedback summary SFS-2025-Q1.

Approvals

Role	Name	Signed	Date
Product Engineering	Jonas Berge	Signed	10 Jun 2025
Quality	Tomas Hrubec	Signed	11 Jun 2025
Service Operations	Marte Lien	Signed	12 Jun 2025

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